

Propertypeak – Staging Sync & Testing Rules (Printable)

This document defines how staging should be used.

PURPOSE OF STAGING

Staging exists to: - Test features safely - Catch bugs early - Mimic production behavior

Staging is allowed to break. Production is not.

WHEN TO SYNC STAGING

Run:

```
sync-prod-to-staging.sh
```

Before: - Testing a new feature - Debugging a data-related issue - Large UI or logic changes

WHEN NOT TO SYNC STAGING

Do NOT sync when: - You created temporary test data - You are mid-test - You want to preserve test-only scenarios

Syncing will overwrite staging data.

WHAT THE SYNC SCRIPT DOES

- Copies production database → staging database
 - Copies production images → staging images
 - Fixes permissions
 - Clears cache
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WHAT GIT DOES (IMPORTANT DIFFERENCE)

Git tracks: - Code changes - File differences - History and rollback

Git does NOT track: - Images - Database content - CMS admin changes

Both tools are required.

TESTING RULES

- Always test on staging first
 - Always test with real data
 - Never test logic on production
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GOLDEN RULES

- Same code must go to staging and production
 - No last-minute production edits
 - Production is read-only mindset
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FINAL PRINCIPLE

Staging builds confidence. Production builds trust.